

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The nature of Brahman: The nature of Brahman as spirit, ultimate reality or absolute truth; how the characteristics of Brahman are shown in Hindu scriptures, including Katha Upanishad 2.2.6–8.
1.2	The nature and importance of understanding Brahman as Nirguna Brahman and Saguna Brahman: how Nirguna Brahman and Saguna Brahman are shown in Hindu scripture, for example Nirguna (Taaittiriya Upanishad 2.7.1–2) and Saguna (Rig Veda 1.154.1–2); the nature and importance of Vaikuntha (spiritual worlds); divergent ways in which belief in each may be expressed in the life of Hindus today.
1.3	Three aspects of the divine: Brahman, Antaryami and Bhagavan; the nature and significance of the divine as Brahman (everywhere and non-personal), Antaryami (within the heart) and Bhagavan (beyond, as a personal loving God); how the three aspects are shown in Hindu scriptures, including Mundaka Upanishad 2.1; why belief in the three aspects of the divine are important in Hindu life and for religious pluralism today.
1.4	Manifestations of the Divine: the nature and importance of how the deities are shown in Hindu scriptures; avatars and murti; the nature and role of male deities: divergent understandings of the importance of Vishnu (including Rig Veda 1.22) and Shiva; the nature and role of the female force, Shakti, including Parvati and Lakshmi.
1.5*	The nature of the individual and life within Hinduism: the nature and importance of the atman (eternal self), karma, the cycle of samsara, moksha; divergent Hindu understandings of the nature of the individual and life, including interpretations of Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 4.4; why beliefs about the atman, karma, samsara and moksha are important for Hindus today.
1.6	The purpose of human life for Hindus: the nature and significance of the four aims of life (Purusharthas) – dharma, artha, kama and moksha; the nature and significance of anatana dharma (eternal law), including Bhagavad Gita 3.35; the nature and significance of varnashrama dharma (duties according to materialistic situation in life).
1.7	Hindu responses to suffering, knowledge and ignorance: Hindu teachings about suffering, knowledge and ignorance such as ahimsa, respect, empathy, mind/sense control, humility, and love, including Mahabharata 5.39; divergent Hindu understandings as to why there is suffering, knowledge and ignorance for Hindus today.
1.8	Hindu cosmology: the nature of the Hindu cosmology as shown in Hindu scriptures, including Rig Veda 10.129; the nature and importance of the cycle of four ages (yugas), including descriptions of the Kali Yuga in the Mahabharata, many worlds and their diverse inhabitants; the nature and divergent understandings of the importance of the concepts of prakriti (matter/nature), tri-guna (three qualities) and maya (illusion).

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage for Hindus: Hindu teachings about the importance and purpose of marriage in Hindu life, including Rig Veda 10.85.36–47; divergent Hindu, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and Hindu responses to them.
2.2	Hindu teachings about the nature and importance of sexual relationships; Hindu teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 5.21–23; divergent Hindu teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Hindu responses to them.
2.3	Hindu teachings about the purpose and importance of the family – procreation, security and education of children, with reference to Bhagavad Gita 1.37–43; divergent Hindu responses to different types of family within 21st century (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the local Hindu community: how and why the community tries to support families (with reference to Bhagavad Gita 1.37–43), including through worship, rites of passage, festivals and counselling; the importance of the support of the local Hindu community for Hindu families today.
2.5	Hindu teaching about family planning and regulation of births: divergent Hindu attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to the householder stage, with reference to Bhagavad Gita 3.37–43; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them.
2.6	Hindu teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage: Hindu teachings about divorce and remarriage, including reference to the Hindu Marriage Act 1955 (India) and arguments used to support or reject divorce; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them.
2.7	Hindu teachings about the equality of men and women in the family: Hindu teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family, including reference to Manusmriti 3.55–60; divergent Hindu attitudes about the equality of men and women in the family.
2.8	Hindu teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Hindu opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.29–32; examples of gender equality in action in Hinduism.